

MGT 439 Topics in Organizational Behavior: Leadership in Practice: Coaching and Inclusion

Syllabus V.13.1 6/17/26

Quarter: Summer 2026

Classroom: MPR2

FW Intensive Class Schedule

<u>Weekend 1: 8/7-8/9/26</u>	<u>Between Weekends</u>	<u>Weekend 2: 8/29-30/26</u>
Friday Aug 7: 6:30-9:00pm Saturday Aug 8: 10:00am-8:00pm Sunday Aug 9: 10:00am-2:00pm	Coaching Exam by appointment; asynchronous module on conflict & feedback	Saturday Aug. 29: 10:00am-4:00pm Sunday Aug. 30: 10:00am-2:00pm

Teaching Team

Instructor: Alison B. Meyer, Leadership Coach & Lecturer
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TA: Syeda Ullah, PhD Candidate, Management Group
Contact: sullah@ucsd.edu

DESCRIPTION

"Leadership is not a talent or a gift. It's a choice. It's not complex, but it's very hard."
– Brigadier General Stanley McChrystal

"Coaching is chiefly about awareness, discovery and choice.
It is a way of effectively empowering people to find their own answers."
– "Co-Active Coaching" Coaches Training Institute

The people working in a company are the biggest asset to the success of the business. But people are complicated. Every employee is different and wants to be seen for their unique value. This complexity can be a challenge. What practices help you develop the conditions where people do their best work?

COURSE OBJECTIVES

Through the two tools of coaching and inclusion, students build their leadership mindset and hands-on skillset. We examine people-management practices to explore how, as a leader of people, do you:

1. Manage people in order to engage and get the best out of each employee, regardless of their style or level?
2. Grow your employees and yourself, so that you scale your impact.
3. Create inclusive environments where people feel they belong and are comfortable with creative friction so they leverage their work to deploy collective genius?

The course sets the stage with a foundational examination of the roles of the manager and the leader. Then moving into skills development, we start with focus on the individual employee through the tool of coaching. Students first learn the basic process of coaching others and receive coaching. Then through deliberate practice, gradually students increase their comfort and agility into ambiguous coaching situations to problem-solve.

Next, looking at groups of people, we explore the paradox of diversity--that diversity among groups of people leads to higher innovation yet also leads to conflict and exclusion. Students work with both behavior and process to develop learning environments where everybody thrives. Outcomes such as whether employees feel they belong, how the culture "feels" to them, and how to balance creative friction can be a result of process and structure, as well as behavior.

This course also guides people managers to look at leadership through the lens of how they think about and interact with their people. This examination culminates in a forward-looking leadership vision, values and practices statement.

INSTRUCTIONAL METHODOLOGY

This class is highly experiential and requires your mental and physical focus. Come to class as well-rested, fed and prepared as is possible (for a person going to graduate school and working full time).

We will work in three modes: preparation, performance, and reflection. This model comes from the theater, but is essential in sports, business and any kind of human performance. In more detail:

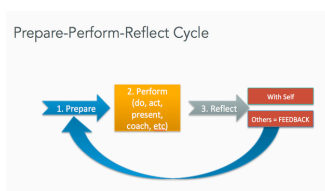
1. Prepare: Preparation involves practice, routines, setting intention, planning, rehearsal, and experimentation. Part of performance preparation is determining how you need to prepare.

2. Perform: Performance involves letting go of the preparation, to be present with what is happening in the moment in order to respond authentically.

Regarding the act of performance, a tennis player cycles serve-by-serve, set-by-set, game-by-game, starting over and over again. The actor gets on stage night after night and starts from scratch with a new audience. Push yourself to make mistakes in performance so you learn.

3. Reflect: Reflection involves looking back at what happened, exploring what was meaningful about it and assessing what you have learned/will do differently, so that you can integrate that learning "next time."

"The debrief is as important as the game." – Steve Ballmer



ATTENDANCE, GRADING & DELIVERABLES

How your grade is calculated

All assignments are to be individually completed, with the exception of the partner Coaching Exam and class engagement. The exam will be completed with a classmate, but is individually graded on your performance as a coach. Qualitative grading criteria for graded assignments include:

- Level of effort. How persistent and curious you choose to be in the work.
- Level of openness and collaboration. How effectively you work with others' perspectives and differences.
- Depth of reflection. How consistently you go beyond the easy answer.
- Level of support. How you help create an environment where everybody is learning.

Limit Device Use to Class Exercises

Because we want you to engage with each other to learn, please limit laptop and smartphone use specifically to in-class exercises and polls. Note-taking on a tablet laid flat is also fine. We will provide each student with a notebook for note-taking and your journaling assignment.

Course Assignments and Deliverables	Percentage of grade
Class Engagement to advance the discussion and experiment in the class exercises	10%
Individual Homework Assignments, except projects	50%
Project: Partner Coaching Exam & Reflection • Exam – 10% • Personal Reflection – 5%	15%
Final Projects • De-Biasing Project • Leadership Vision	25%
Total	100%

Attendance – Summer Intensive

It is very difficult to make up for an absence, due to the experiential learning of the lab environment. You must attend all sessions of the two weekends to achieve a passing grade.

Late Assignments

In order for students to engage in in-class exercises, readings and assignments must be completed prior to the class for which they are assigned. Late assignments will receive a 20% deduction per day past the due date. Partial days are rounded up to full days.

Medical/family emergencies

We understand life can have unexpected events that interrupt learning. If you are experiencing a health or family issue and need additional time to complete assignments, please reach out to the teaching team for options.

Grade Disputes

If you perceive a grading error, you must report it via email to both the Instructor and the Reader within 7 days of appearing on Canvas course site. State what is the error you perceive and provide the assignment materials if we do not have them. We will review and reply within 14 days of receiving your email. After re-grading review, your grade may increase, stay the same, or decrease.

MATERIALS

Books

1. HBR Guide to Coaching Employees, Copyright 2015 Harvard Business School Publishing Corp
2. The Coaching Habit, Michael Bungay Stanier, 2016, Box of Crayons Press
3. How to Be an Inclusive Leader, 2nd Edition, Jennifer Brown, 2022, Berrett-Koehler Publishers, inc.

StudyNet Reader on Canvas

1. The Leader as Coach: How to unleash innovation, energy, and commitment. Herminia Ibarra & Anne Scoular, HBR Nov-Dec 2019.
2. Want to Be an Outstanding Leader? Keep a Journal. Nancy J. Adler, HBR 1/13/2016
3. Ros Atkins and the 50:50 Project at the BBC (A)
4. Leadership That Gets Results. Daniel Goleman, 2000 (HBR Bestseller)
5. Designing a Bias-Free Organization, Iris Bohnet & Gardiner Morse, HBR July-August 2016
6. How the Best Bosses Interrupt Bias on Their Teams. Joan C. Williams and Sky Mihaylo, HBR Nov-Dec 2019
7. How to be a CEO, From a Decade's Worth of Them, Adam Bryant, New York Times, 10/27/2017
8. If There's Only One Woman in Your Candidate Pool, There's Statistically No Chance She'll Be Hired, Stefanie K. Johnson, David R. Hekman, and Elsa T. Chan
9. Leveraging Diversity Through Psychological Safety. Amy Edmonson & Kathryn Roloff. Rotman Magazine Fall 2009/ROT093

Note that other readings may be added to supplement the above as the topic shifts due to current events...

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind. The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at:

<http://senate.ucsd.edu/manual/appendices/appendix2.pdf>

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member. The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. No accommodations can be implemented retroactively. Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or fosorio@ucsd.edu.

COURSE ACTIVITIES BY MODULE

Schedule as of 6/17/26

Times are fixed; activities may shift slightly. Please see canvas for precise due dates and times.

Subscribe to the class calendar on canvas to import deliverable due dates into your own calendar. See <https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Canvas-Basics-Guide/How-do-I-use-the-Calendar/ta-p/617613> for info on setting this up.

< 2026 Leadership in Practice Summer Intensive Schedule - For Students

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	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	Attendance Policy – Summer Intensive <i>It is very difficult to make up for an absence, due to the experiential learning of the lab environment. You must attend all sessions of the two weekends to achieve a passing grade. For questions, please reach out to Professor Alison Meyer: abmeyer@ucsd.edu</i>							
2	Prework		Weekend 1				Weekend 2	
3		Hours	Fri Aug 7	Sat Aug 8	Sun Aug 9	between class 1 & 2 by appt	Sat Aug 29	Sun Aug 30
4			Class 1	Class 2	Class 3	Coaching Exam	Class 4	Class 5
5	Synchronous class time in purple	each cell = 1 hour of class time:	Set the Stage Active Listening	Inclusive Leadership, Coaching	Inclusive Leadership, Coaching	Coaching Exam - Partner Exercise	Debiasing Projects	Leadership Manifestos
6			Module 1 & 2	Module 3, 4, 5	Module 6	Module 7 - asynch.	Module 8 & 9	Module 10
7								
8	Due before class 1	10:00 AM		10:00 AM	10:00 AM		10:00 AM	10:00 AM
9	see canvas	11:00 AM						
10		12:00 PM					panel (12:30)	
11		1:00 PM			2:00 PM			2:00 PM
12		2:00 PM		Panel				
13		3:00 PM					4:00 PM	
14		4:00 PM				*By appt exam*		
15		5:00 PM				*asynch. module 7*		
16		6:00 PM	6:30 PM	Dinner				
17		7:00 PM		8:00 PM				
18		8:00 PM	9:00 PM					
19								
20	total synchronous hours (30 hours for 4-unit course)		2.5	10	4	3	6	4
21								
22								
23	meal plan			coffee/pastries	coffee/pastries		coffee/pastries	coffee/pastries
24			regular dinner	lunch - guest spkr			guest panel:	
25			dessert break 7:45 pm	special dinner with guests 6 pm	lunch - 30 mins @ 12:30p		lunch	lunch

Module 1

Set the Stage: The Practice of Leadership

Objectives

- Introduce "leadership in practice" and the "leadership lab" of learning through doing
- Start building one's power of presence
- Analyze and classify behaviors of people managers according to positive or negative impact
- Homework set up: Daily Journaling

Readings

- Reader: "The Leader as Coach"
- Reader: "Leadership That Gets Results"

Pre-Work

- **1_1: Building community**: add your picture to canvas.
- **1_2: PDP Reflection and Current Goals – Discussion Board**: In MGT 406 Leadership class you wrote a comprehensive PDP. As you come into the coaching class where you will give and receive coaching, this is a good time to review and reflect on your plans.

Study Questions

- Think about managers you've had. Who had a positive or negative impact on you? Why? What did they do?
- How can your manager help create an environment where you thrive?
- Who is responsible for creating an inclusive work environment where people feel they belong and can do their best work?

Module 2

Active Listening

Topics

- What are different leadership styles and when to use them.
- How to listen actively – skills and behaviors.

Readings

- Book: "HBR Guide" Ch. 1: "Shift Your Thinking to Coach Effectively"
- Reader: "Want to Be an Outstanding Leader? Keep A Journal."

Study Questions

- What leadership style(s) do you use most often? Which style do you think you could use more of? Why?
- As a manager, how do you motivate and guide people?
- How can you listen empathetically?

Weekend 1, Class 2 Saturday August 8th
 Module 3: Inclusive Leadership
 Module 4: Coaching Basics: The GROW Model
 Module 5: Coaching Skills 2

Module 3 Inclusive Leadership

Topics

- Empathy for groups: inclusion and culture
- What is inclusive leadership?
- Practicing active listening and empathy

Readings

- Book: "How to Be an Inclusive Leader" read intro and chapters 1, 2, 3 -- "Introduction: From Unaware to Advocate" through Ch. 3 "Aware"
- Optional Reader: "Leveraging Diversity Through Psychological Safety"

Pre-Work

1. **Assignment 2_1 (nothing to turn in) Day after class 1:** Start journaling at the beginning or end of each day for 5 to 15 minutes, by hand. Make it a regular, daily ritual. Use the reading on journaling as a guide.

In-Class Exercises

2. **Assignment 3_2 Inclusion Belonging Experience**
3. **Assignment 2_2 Active Listening conversations:** prepare, perform, reflect. Practice active listening with 2 different people

Study Questions

- What would you need to measure to know if you are being an inclusive leader?
- What's a first step you can take to create more inclusion in your workplace?
- Imagine your ideal company -- what is the culture like?

Module 4 Coaching Basics: The GROW Model

Topics

- What are the basic behaviors and skills to start coaching?
- How to use the GROW Model to organize a coaching conversation

Readings

- Book: "HBR Guide" Ch. 2 "Set the Stage for Coaching"
- The Coaching Habit: read through question 3, especially pgs. 35-48 (Q1), 55-67 (Q2), 79-92 (Q3), 107 (Q1-3 together)
- "Coaching Questions List" – see course website

Study Questions

- How effective are you at listening? What do you need to work on to improve?
- Is everyone coachable? Why or why not?
- How comfortable are you with using playback? With using silence?

Module 5

Coaching Skills 2/GROW Model

Topics

- Continue exploring the mindset and skillset of coaching
- Difference between ask and tell
- Using coaching questions

Readings

- The Coaching Habit, pgs. 109-116 & 126 (Q4), 127- 131 (silence), 134-147 (Q5)
- (Optional) HBR Guide, Ch. 10: "Avoid Common Coaching Mistakes"

Study Questions

- What is the purpose of structuring coaching with the GROW model?
 - Read through the "Coaching Questions List." What questions most resonate (positively or negatively) for you? Choose 3 questions to put on your coaching session preparation go-to
 - When is coaching the wrong tool?
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Module 6
Cognitive Bias, Inclusion, and Leading Change

Topics

- How does coaching influence inclusion, and vice versa?
- Explore the many ways inclusion issues affect people
- Case: Ros Atkins and the 50:50 Project at the BBC (A)

Readings

- Reader: "Ros Atkins and the 50:50 Project at the BBC (A)"
- Book: "How to Be an Inclusive Leader" chapters: Ch. 4 "Active" and Ch. 5 "Advocate"
- (Optional) Canvas: McKinsey Report: "Diversity Wins How Inclusion Matters" – [read executive summary](#)

In-Class Exercises

1. **Assignment 6_2 Discussion Board: Inclusive Leadership in the News:** see instructions on canvas.
2. **Assignment 6_3 Sign up for Partner Coaching Exam:** find a partner and sign up for a 60-minute appointment. Details on canvas.

After Class Work

- **DUE 1 week after Module 5 Assignment 5_2 Practice Coaching Sessions:** see instructions on canvas.
- **DUE 2 weeks after Module 6 Assignment 6_1 Practice Coaching Sessions – Round 2:** see instructions on canvas.

Study Questions

- Why was the 50:50 Project at the BBC so successful?
 - How could you use this program as a model to build inclusion and equity in your organization?
 - How can you uncover and rework unintentionally biased organization processes?
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To complete between Weekend 1 & 2
ASYNCHRONOUS

Module 7

Feedback, Dialogue, and Conflict Coaching Exam

Topics

- Guidance: The Art and Practice of Feedback.
- Skills and behaviors for addressing and managing conflict

Readings

- Book: The Coaching Habit, pgs 153-171 (Q6) and pgs 180-195 (Q7)
- Podcast "The Four Types of Conflict and How to Manage Them" http://bit.ly/Gallo_4TypesofConflict
- Webpage: Situation-Behavior-Impact Model http://bit.ly/SBI_Model_CCL
- (Video – 21 mins) Radical Candor: The Surprising Secret to Being a Good Boss – link: <https://youtu.be/4yODaLQ2IM>
- Optional – more on feedback: HBR Guide: 6: "Giving Feedback That Sticks"

Pre-Work

- **Assignment 7_2 Coaching Exam**
 - **Assignment 7_2A Coaching Exam with a Partner**: Students in groups of 2 will come to office hours over video to coach each other and be assessed on coaching skill progress. Appointments are 60 minutes per pair.
 - **Assignment 7_2B Reflection on Coaching Exam**: see details on canvas.
- **Assignment 7_3 Feedback in Action – Discussion Board**: After the readings on feedback and conflict, choose a practice to try out in real life. Share a reflection on what you did and how it went, and coach/comment on a peer's work.

Study Questions

- What questions are working well for you in coaching?
 - How trustworthy are you perceived to be?
 - What can you do to improve the impact of your feedback?
 - Do you tend to avoid conflict or seek it out?
 - What would help you increase your ability to stay engaged where there is conflict?
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Module 8 Inclusion by Process: De-Biasing in Action

Topics

- Methods for how to debias a process or structure.
- Presentation of individual de-biasing projects

Readings

- Reader: How the Best Bosses Interrupt Bias on their Teams
- Webpage: "Ten Evidence-Based Practices for De-Biasing the Workplace" http://bit.ly/Ten_Debiasing_Practices_Bohnet (Links to an external site.)
- Webpage/download - Playbook: "Advancing Belonging in Organizations" – see link below
- Reader: "Designing a Bias-Free Organization"
- (Optional) Reader: "If There's Only One Woman in Your Candidate Pool, There's Statistically No Chance She'll Be Hired"

Further Resources on Debiasing

- Industry Playbooks from BerkeleyHaas Center for Equity, Gender, and Leadership
 - Includes playbooks for "Advancing Belonging in Organizations", "Advancing Language for Equity & Inclusion", "Supporting Dual Career Couples" and other playbooks

Pre-Work

- **Assignment 5_1 Reflection on Reflection**: see instructions on canvas.
- **Assignment 8_1 De-Biasing Project**: Using the readings on debiasing, choose a process or structure from your organization or community to de-bias. Analyze what specific action steps the organization would need to take to remove bias from that process. Be prepared to present the project and steps in class, 4-5 minutes per person.

Study Questions

- Can you get rid of all bias in organizational structures and processes?
- Which tools from class could help with this?
 - How can you encourage / create a "learning organization"? (This term was introduced in our Class 1 reading "The Leader as Coach.")

Module 9 Inclusion by Process: De-Biasing in Action

Topics

- Methods for how to debias a process or structure.
- Presentation of individual de-biasing projects

Readings

- No assigned readings

In Class Assignments

- 9_1 Discussion Boards on Projects – will be assigned in class.

Study Questions

- What are you learning from the de-biasing projects?
 - What new issues are you seeing around you in your organization and community that you were not aware of before?
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Module 10 Putting it Together

Topics

- Skills and Behaviors you wish to build moving forward

Readings

- Reader: "How to be a CEO, From a Decade's Worth of Them."
- Book: "How to Be an Inclusive Leader" Ch. 6 "Staying Committed to the Journey"

Pre-Work

- **Assignment 10_1. Leadership Vision:** Integrate the parts of your work into a "manifesto" of your perspective and practices on managing people. What have you learned, what must you do, where do you need to grow. What have you added to your leadership toolkit? Submit Paper on course website and bring a color version of your "one slide" to present in Class.

Study Questions

- What is your vision for your team?
 - What are your key takeaways from the course for your own professional development journey?
 - Compared to Class 1, where are you now on the Inclusive Leader continuum (unaware, aware, active, advocate)? Where do you go from here?
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